Ryan Donohue

Systems Administrator
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT professional with 7+ years of progressive experience spanning service desk, systems administration, and team leadership. Skilled across Windows Server, Active Directory, Microsoft Azure, virtualization, and Linux environments. Hands-on experience managing complex, multi-client infrastructures for government and medical organizations. Passionate about automation, self-hosted infrastructure, and building reliable, scalable IT solutions.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Systems Analyst / Microsoft Exchange Engineer · M&T Bank (via TEK Systems) · Buffalo, NY
Nov 2024 – Present

- Contracted through TEK Systems to support M&T Bank's enterprise messaging and email security infrastructure across a large-scale Microsoft Exchange environment.
- Administer and enforce email security protocols including SMTP, SecSMTP, DMARC, DKIM, and SPF to protect organizational mail flow and ensure compliance with industry security standards.
- Manage and maintain Proofpoint email security and Cisco IronPort appliances for inbound/outbound mail filtering, threat protection, and policy enforcement.
- Actively involved in hands-on development and rollout of new Outlook and Exchange features, contributing to testing, validation, and deployment in a production enterprise environment.
- Write and maintain PowerShell scripts on a near-daily basis to automate Exchange administration tasks, reporting, and operational workflows.

Systems Administrator → Senior Systems Administrator / Team Lead · Personal Computers Inc. (PCI) · Buffalo, NY *May 2017 – Jun 2024*
Promoted through three roles over 7 years: Service Desk Representative → Systems Administrator → Senior Systems Administrator & Team Lead

- Started in service desk providing phone-based triage and on-site support for Windows and Apple environments; quickly earned a reputation for thorough diagnostics and escalation management, leading to promotion into a systems administration role.
- Administered Windows Server, Linux, Microsoft Azure, and AWS infrastructures for a diverse client base including government agencies and medical organizations; managed Microsoft Hyper-V and cloud virtualization environments to optimize performance, security, and uptime.
- Advanced to Senior Systems Administrator and Team Lead, managing a team of administrators to deliver client projects on scope and on schedule across Windows, Linux, Azure, and AWS environments.
- Designed and executed a full Windows Server 2016 → 2022 migration for medical tenant RDS environments and production applications, including building, testing, and deploying production-level architecture with live troubleshooting alongside active users.
- Architected and deployed an automated patching and maintenance system using Datto RMM, replacing entirely manual update workflows across all managed tenants and coordinating schedules to minimize client impact.
- Served as escalation point and primary client liaison; analyzed business requirements, translated them into technical specifications, led user acceptance testing, and provided post-deployment support.
- Maintained backup, data security, and disaster recovery procedures across client environments; adhered to industry standards for environment commissioning and decommissioning.

PROJECTS

Windows Server Migration & Upgrade – PCI *Apr 2023 – Jan 2024*

- Migrated production RDS server environments and medical applications from Windows Server 2016 to Windows Server 2022 architecture.
- Responsible for building, testing, and deploying production-level infrastructure with live troubleshooting alongside active end users.

Tenant Patching & Maintenance Overhaul – PCI *May 2022 – May 2023*

- Replaced entirely manual server patching and maintenance with an automated workflow on the Datto RMM platform.
- Wrote automation scripts to handle update scheduling, patching sequencing, and maintenance tasks across all managed tenants.
- Coordinated patching windows to avoid overlap with client business hours; produced full procedural documentation.

Self-Hosted Home Lab & Home Automation Platform – Personal *2022 – Present*

- Built and maintain a ZimaCube x86 home server running ZimaOS with a Docker-based services stack including Home Assistant, AdGuard Home, Immich (self-hosted photo management), Tailscale VPN, Cloudflared tunneling, Glances monitoring, and Ollama (local AI inference).
- Designed and administer a RAID1 storage array and manage a multi-container Docker environment without Compose, using manual container lifecycle management and custom run scripts to ensure stability across updates.
- Authored extensive Home Assistant YAML automation, including Zigbee device integration via ZHA (Sonoff USB dongle), presence detection, laundry cycle detection via vibration sensors, morning weather briefings, and multi-zone lighting scenes.
- Diagnosed and resolved a critical Zigbee device-passthrough regression caused by a silent --device flag drop during Docker container recreation — tracing the issue across container inspect output, ZHA logs, and restart behavior.

Personal Website & Portfolio – rdonohue.com *2023 – Present*

- Designed and built a dual-site portfolio (rdonohue.com and dj.rdonohue.com) from scratch using custom HTML, CSS, and JavaScript — no frameworks or templates.
- Deployed via Cloudflare Pages with custom domain routing and redirect rules; configured Cloudflare DNS, CDN, and tunnel settings for both public-facing and self-hosted services.

3D Printing & Fabrication Automation – Personal *2023 – Present*

- Operate a Bambu Lab P1S FDM printer integrated into a broader home automation workflow, with print status monitored via Home Assistant dashboard cards.
- Design and print custom hardware including server rack components, cable management brackets, cabinet hardware, and precision jigs for woodworking projects.
- Leverage the P1S multi-material and remote monitoring capabilities to run unattended production prints, with completion notifications delivered via Home Assistant mobile alerts.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Information Systems · SUNY Buffalo State College · *Graduated with High Honors*

A.A. Liberal Arts · Erie Community College · *Graduated with High Honors*